Data Retention Policy

POL-COMP-001 · Version 3.0 · Effective 2025-02-01

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Data Retention Policy (POL-COMP-001, version 3.0) is to establish guidelines for the retention and deletion of data processed and stored by the systems used at Acme Corp. This policy is intended to ensure compliance with regulatory requirements, protect customer information, and preserve the integrity of business operations.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all data generated, processed, or stored in the following systems:

- Ledger DB
- Data Warehouse
- Audit Log Store
- Kafka Cluster
- Support Desk

This policy encompasses all employees, contractors, and third-party service providers who interact with these systems.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Data Retention Periods

- Customer application logs are retained for **13 months** and then permanently deleted.
- Payment transaction records in the **Ledger DB** are retained for **7 years**.
- Audit logs in the **Audit Log Store** are retained for **7 years** and are immutable.
- Support tickets in the **Support Desk** are retained for **3 years** after closure.
- Messages in **Kafka Cluster** topics are retained for **7 days**.

3.2 Legal Holds

In situations where a legal hold is enacted, all scheduled deletion processes for the affected records will be suspended until the legal hold is lifted. This applies to any data across all systems mentioned in this policy.

3.3 Secure Deletion

Upon reaching the end of the designated retention period, all data must be securely deleted. Secure deletion methods must comply with the standards outlined in the **POL-COMP-005: Encryption and Key Management Policy** to ensure that data cannot be recovered or reconstructed.

3.4 Data Backup and Recovery

Backups of data must be performed in accordance with the **POL-COMP-007: Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Policy**. Data that has reached the end of its retention period should not be included in backups unless a legal hold is in effect.

3.5 Compliance and Auditing

Regular audits will be conducted to ensure compliance with this policy. The owning team for each system must maintain records of all data retention and deletion activities, including any legal holds that have been enacted.

3.6 Data Access and Security

Access to retained data is governed by the **POL-COMP-004: Access Control Policy**. Only authorized personnel may access sensitive data, and all access must be logged for auditing purposes.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

- The owning team for each system is responsible for implementing and maintaining the data retention and deletion processes as outlined in this policy.
- The Incident Commander is responsible for ensuring that any legal holds are communicated promptly to all relevant stakeholders.
- The on-call engineer must monitor compliance with the retention schedules and report any discrepancies or issues to the appropriate personnel.
- All employees are responsible for adhering to this policy and reporting any potential violations or concerns to their supervisor.

5. Exceptions

Any exceptions to this policy must be documented and approved by the appropriate authority. Requests for exceptions should detail the rationale and duration for the exception. Exceptions may be granted for the following:

- Specific regulatory requirements that dictate different retention periods.
- Business needs that require extended retention of certain records beyond what is typically allowed.

- Situations involving ongoing investigations or legal matters, where data must be retained for an extended period.

6. Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary actions, up to and including termination of employment or contract. Enforcement of this policy is the responsibility of the owning teams and the Incident Commander, who must ensure that all individuals comply with the established data retention schedules.

Failure to adhere to this policy may also result in legal ramifications for Acme Corp, including fines or penalties imposed by regulatory bodies. Regular training and updates will be provided to ensure that all personnel understand their responsibilities under this policy.

7. Related Documents

This Data Retention Policy should be read in conjunction with the following documents:

- **POL-COMP-002: Acceptable Use Policy**: Guidelines on acceptable use of company resources, including data handling practices.
- **POL-COMP-003: Incident Response Policy**: Procedures for responding to incidents that may affect data integrity or security.
- **POL-COMP-004: Access Control Policy**: Standards governing access to sensitive data and systems.
- **POL-COMP-005: Encryption and Key Management Policy**: Requirements for data encryption and management of encryption keys to protect sensitive information.

By adhering to this policy, Acme Corp aims to maintain the integrity, security, and compliance of its data management practices while ensuring that customer trust is upheld.